

■ **Topic 3: Biodiversity Under Threat.**

The inequality in resource use is reflected in consumption patterns. A large number of resources are used by a small number of large economies, whereas many countries could be said not to use their 'fair share'. These issues are investigated through the study of:

■ **Topic 4: Superpower Geographies**

■ **Topic 5: Bridging the Development Gap.**

The role of technology in overcoming resource scarcity, income inequality and environmental management is considered by investigating:

■ **Topic 6: The Technological Fix?**

3.2 Assessment information

Time

2 hour and 30 minute examination paper comprising of **two** sections and a resource booklet including synoptic resources.

Questions and marks

Candidates will be asked to select and answer **two** questions from **five** in Section A and all questions in Section B.

Section A will consist of a choice of **two** data stimulus essay questions from **five** each totalling 25 marks. The five questions will be based on five of the six topics for Unit 3.

Section B (Synoptic investigation) will focus on the sixth topic unexamined in Section A. This topic will change in each exam sitting and will be revealed through the pre-released advance information. Section B will consist of one question in three parts. The total mark for the question will be 40. The question will make use of the pre-released synoptic materials reproduced in the examination resource booklet.

There are a total of 90 marks for the complete examination.

Materials

A resource booklet will be provided in the examination. This will include synoptic resources. The synoptic resources only will be **pre-released** to candidates as advance information **four** working weeks before the examination via the Edexcel website (www.edexcel.org.uk). There is no restriction on the use of pre-released synoptic resources in teaching prior to the examination.

Candidates must **not** take their pre-released synoptic resources into the examination as these will be reproduced in the resource booklet.

Synoptic investigation

Students should develop an overview which links the six topics and addresses the question of 'managing the contested planet'. This should take the form of an assessment of:

1 — Players — the role of individuals, pressure groups and political movements, governments, business and international agencies in monitoring and managing the planet. This should include the views held by these players, and an understanding of the basis for holding these views, for instance the value different players place on questions of conservation, development and the future of the planet

2 — Actions — the role of local, national and international actions. This should include an assessment of why actions at some scales are more achievable and successful than at others. Contrasts between neo-liberal, market-led approaches and socialist and grassroots models, as well as sustainable development, should be made

3 — Futures — the question of the future of the planet should be addressed through a comparison of 'business as usual' models, sustainable futures which may alter the 'future' but possibly not enough to prevent many problems, and more radical approaches involving concepts such as 'green growth'.